

STARTER TEMPLATE · ADAPT BEFORE ADOPTION

CDFI Grant AI Evidence Checklist

A mission-first checklist for documenting AI-assisted work in grant, impact, and community-development evidence files.

WHO IT IS FOR

CDFI, MDI, community development, grants, and impact teams

FILL TIME

7 min

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Grant or impact goal
- 02 AI-assisted task
- 03 Data boundary
- 04 Evidence retained
- 05 Fairness and mission check
- 06 Reporting note

SECTION 01

Grant or impact goal

Name the mission outcome the AI-assisted work supports. Keep the language tied to the grant, program, or community-development plan rather than the tool.

- ^a Program, grant, or internal initiative name.
- ^a Target community, member, borrower, or small-business segment.
- ^a Outcome being supported: access, speed, language clarity, documentation quality, or staff capacity.

SECTION 02

AI-assisted task

Describe the exact staff task where AI helps. The task should be internal and reviewable before any member, borrower, funder, or examiner sees the output.

- ^a Drafting narrative, summarizing outreach notes, organizing evidence, or improving plain-language explanations.
- ^a Approved tool and owner.
- ^a Human reviewer and backup reviewer.

SECTION 03

Data boundary

State what may and may not enter the AI tool. If real member, borrower, or applicant data is not allowed, write that plainly.

- ^a Allowed inputs: public program language, internal templates, de-identified summaries, or synthetic examples.
- ^a Blocked inputs: NPI, account numbers, loan details, full applications, demographic data, or examination-sensitive material unless an approved private tool and agreement cover it.
- ^a Sanitization step before prompting.

SECTION 04

Evidence retained

Keep enough evidence to show the work was controlled without turning the file into a tool log dump.

- ^a Prompt or working brief used.
- ^a Source material referenced.
- ^a AI draft or summary, if retained under policy.
- ^a Reviewer note, correction, and final-use decision.
- ^a Where the final artifact is stored.

SECTION 05

Fairness and mission check

Before using the output, ask whether the AI-assisted work could narrow access, confuse applicants, or hide a policy decision.

- ^a Does the output preserve the institution's mission and plain-language standard?
- ^a Could any member, borrower, or applicant group be disadvantaged by the wording or process?
- ^a Did a human verify that the output matches approved program criteria?

SECTION 06

Reporting note

When the work supports a grant file or impact report, add a short note that separates AI assistance from the institution's final judgment.

1. Describe the human-owned decision or final artifact.
2. Name the AI-assisted support task.
3. Name the reviewer and date.
4. Reference the retained evidence file.

SOURCE BASIS

- AIEOG AI Lexicon — AI governance, AI use case inventory
- Your grant agreement, award conditions, and reporting instructions
- Institution records retention policy

ADAPT BEFORE ADOPTION

This is a starter template, not legal advice or an examiner-approved policy. Replace every [bracketed] placeholder, align the language with your institution's policies, and route the final document through compliance, risk, and legal review.